

User interface

It supports pop-up notifications about the playback. Tracks can be added or removed and arranged in any order, simply by dragging and dropping. Media metadata is stored using Sqlite 3, which is displayed in a simple and easy to navigate hierarchical tree structure.

Features

- **File tracking:** It keeps track of all the files, so there is no need to worry about importing a library after moving files from one folder to another, or renaming them.
- **Supports any playback format:** It can play any format supported by Gstreamer.

Tomahawk

Tomahawk is a full-featured media player developed by Christian Muehlhaeuser.

Its first release was on March 24, 2011. It is written in C++ using QT.



User interface

Tomahawk has a very simple and clutter-free interface. The control bar has been integrated with the main menu bar and playback can be controlled by the media control buttons on the keyboard. This makes Tomahawk much easier to control compared to other players. It has a very ordered layout with all the collections on the sidebar, where you can browse your local music database according to artists, songs, albums, recently played songs, favourites, etc. It also displays the number of times a track or artist plays and similar tracks from the Internet in a very intuitive way.

Features

- **Media scanning:** On start-up, it automatically scans for all the media files on the disk (you can select a particular folder from Settings) and adds them to the player; so there is no need to import songs regularly if they are modified or moved.
- **Updates about new releases:** It keeps the user up-to-date with new albums and track releases. Tracks can be downloaded and played easily within the Tomahawk player.

- **Sharing of playlists:** It has an out-of-the-box feature of public and private listening, where you can share your playlists and current tracks publicly or enjoy your music privately.
- **Online playback:** It is capable of handling online music collections from cloud storage services like Drive, 4Shared, and many others just as simply as your offline collection.
- **Connects to your social network account:** You can connect to other Tomahawk players in your local network and also to your Twitter or G+ accounts, and it will automatically post updates of the track you're listening to.

Banshee

Banshee was formerly known as Sonance. The project was started by Aaron Bockover in 2005 and is currently maintained by Aaron Bockover, Andres G Aragonese, Alexander Kojevnikov, Bertrand Lorentz, and Gabriel Burt. It is a part of the GNOME desktop environment.

Its first release was on February 17, 2005. It is written in C# using GTK# (.NET binding for the GTK GUI toolkit) currently being ported to GTK3. It uses the Gstreamer framework to play audio files.

User interface

It has a notification pop-up feature in GNOME. Banshee supports a number of plugins. It has a simple and clutter-free layout and file search is quite fast and impressive.

Features

- **Support for 'DJing':** It also has an auto DJ feature in which it automatically queues up random tracks.
- **Library import:** It supports importing libraries from Amarok, Rhythmbox and iTunes.
- **Buy tracks online:** You can browse and buy tracks from online stores like Amazon from within the player.
- It supports DAAP (Digital Audio Access Protocol) music sharing with the iTunes library and other compatible applications.
- It also lets you organise your audio books and lecture notes, etc.

A comparative study

Amarok: The tabs are arranged properly, which makes it easy for me to navigate through the player without any difficulty. I found its playback to be quite smooth with the help of its crossfading engine (one of my favourite features in a music player). Online sources kept me updated about the information of the track I was listening to. I could even import my iTunes library to Amarok, which was very helpful while porting from Mac to Linux. If you are porting from Windows or Mac to Linux, and if iTunes was your default music player, my recommendation for you would be Amarok.